

Shannon Thomas

DevOps Engineer (ITOps / Commissioning) | Aspiring Full Stack & AI/ML Innovator

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<https://github.com/Shanmeistero> | Portfolio: <https://v0-dev-ops-portfolio-two.vercel.app/>

Professional Summary

Passionate tech explorer with over 10 years in the IT and software engineering landscape, blending hands-on experience in DevOps automation, CI/CD pipelines, and cloud infrastructure with an ever-evolving passion for full-stack development and AI/ML-assisted innovation.

As a DevOps Engineer within commissioning and IT operations, I leverage Python, Linux, and automation tooling to solve complex deployment challenges, streamline delivery, and enhance developer productivity. My work bridges infrastructure and software development — from Kubernetes and Ansible automation to GitLab and Azure DevOps pipelines — creating reliable, scalable environments that drive business outcomes.

Curiosity and collaboration define my approach. I thrive at the intersection of systems, code, and creativity, constantly learning new technologies to architect next-generation solutions and share knowledge with those around me.

Core Competencies

- DevOps & Automation: CI/CD (GitLab, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, npm), IaC (Ansible, Terraform), Containerization (Docker, Azure IoT Edge), Orchestration (Kubernetes, GKE)
- Cloud Platforms: Azure (strong), AWS & GCP (intermediate), Vercel
- Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell
- Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu), Windows (Server and Desktop)
- Networking & Security: TCP/IP, VLAN, SSH, Nginx, SSL/TLS, Firewalls, Fail2ban, Postman
- Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite3, Django ORM
- Tools & Utilities: WSL2, Git, VS Code, Vim
- Learning & Growth: Full Stack Development (HTML, CSS, JS, NodeJS, NextJS, TypeScript, React), Machine Learning & Data Science (Python)

Key Achievements

- Accelerated deployment efficiency by ~85% at Stone Three with team-collaboration for a project, reducing multi-server provisioning from two weeks to under two days using Ansible automation and custom ISO builds for Hyper-V clients.

- Optimized commissioning operations by improving 70% of infrastructure deployment workflows — introducing automated network/firewall testing, pre-provisioning installs, and refined version management in collaboration with development teams.
- Promoted to first team lead at Wonderlabz for initiative and mentorship; trained two engineers, one of whom progressed to team lead within months.
- Spearheaded CI/CD improvements using GitLab and Azure DevOps, ensuring stable and consistent release cycles across distributed systems.
- Developed multiple open-source and personal DevOps projects, including GitOps pipelines, Terraform-based provisioning, and containerized app environments.

Professional Experience

Stone Three — Application Support / DevOps Engineer (Mar 2021 – Present, Somerset West, South Africa)

- Automated and deployed sensor and analytics solutions leveraging Azure IoT Edge, Ansible, and Python scripting.
- Managed Linux and Windows infrastructure across multiple environments, ensuring reliability and scalability of deployments.
- Led commissioning activities for on-prem and cloud hybrid systems, focusing on automation, deployment, and testing.
- Improved team efficiency through internal tools, documentation, and automation scripts.
- Contributed to the development and integration of CI/CD pipelines and cloud infrastructure under Azure DevOps and GitLab CI.

Tech Stack: Azure, IoT Edge, Ansible, Docker, Python, GitLab, PostgreSQL, Bash, Linux (Ubuntu)

Wonderlabz (Playsafe) — NOC Engineer & Team Lead (Apr 2020 – Feb 2021, Cape Town, South Africa)

- Oversaw CI/CD processes using Ansible Tower and GoCD, maintaining uptime for production services.
- Containerized applications using Docker, deployed on GCP and Kubernetes clusters.
- Administered MongoDB environments and handled incident response through JIRA and PagerDuty.
- Mentored team members and established monitoring metrics using GCP dashboards and Splunk.

Tech Stack: Ansible Tower, Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, Splunk, MongoDB, Git, Bash

Northlink College — Senior Enterprise Support Technician (Mar 2012 – Apr 2020, Cape Town, South Africa)

- Managed enterprise-scale Windows and Linux systems, virtualization, and network operations across multiple campuses.
- Maintained Active Directory, Office 365, and VMware environments, ensuring consistent system performance.
- Delivered end-user support and internal system automation; promoted from intern to senior technician within 8 years.

ZaPOP — Junior IT Support Technician (Oct 2011 – Mar 2012, Bellville, South Africa)

- Provided technical support for Linux/Windows environments and assisted with virtualization and FTP/web server setup.
- Supported hardware assembly, installation, and remote troubleshooting for client infrastructure.

Education & Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: DevOps Engineer Expert — 2023
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate — 2023
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals — 2022
- Docker Mastery: Kubernetes + Swarm (Udemy) — 2020
- AWS Concepts & DevOps Essentials (Udemy) — 2019
- CompTIA A+ & Network+ (Northlink College) — 2011
- Matric Certificate — Sarepta Secondary — 2009
- Python Programming (Stone Three, 2022)
- Cisco CCNA Network Fundamentals (Udemy) — 2018
- Linux & Windows Server Administration (Udemy) — 2019
- Actively pursuing CCNA, CKAD, AWS, and GCP certifications

Personal Projects

- DevOps GitOps Infra – Infrastructure as Code automation using Terraform and Ansible
- GitOps Pipeline Demo – CI/CD workflow example integrating GitHub Actions and Kubernetes
- Infra Provisioning Demo – Python + Terraform hybrid provisioning script
- Simple Shell – Bash utility collection for local automation and testing

View full repositories on GitHub: <https://github.com/Shanmeistero>

References

Available upon request (Full contact details available in extended version)